

CENTRE STATE AND INTER STATE RELATIONS

THE FOUR-DIMENSIONAL FEDERAL RELATIONS → LEGISLATIVE COMPETENCE BEFORE CONFLICT → PARLIAMENT'S ROUTES INTO THE → DOCTRINES, REPUGNANCY AND STATE-LAW → ADMINISTRATIVE DIRECTIONS, DELEGATION AND → FISCAL FEDERALISM FROM TAX

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure: the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g2 repaired in place for answer-line and visual-boundary quality • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

THE FOUR-DIMENSIONAL FEDERAL RELATIONS MAP

THE FOUR-DIMENSIONAL FEDERAL RELATIONS MAP

CENTRE-STATE AND INTER-STATE RELATIONS

ARTICLES 245-255 + SEVENTH SCHEDULE

ARTICLES 256-263

ARTICLES 264-293 + GST ARTICLES 246A

ARTICLES 261-263 AND 301-307

OPERATING QUESTION

WHO MAY ACT

CENTRE-STATE AND INTER-STATE RELATIONS

LEGISLATIVE: Articles 245-255 + Seventh Schedule

ADMINISTRATIVE: Articles 256-263

FINANCIAL: Articles 264-293 + GST Articles 246A / 269A / 279A

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

CENTRE-STATE AND INTER-STATE RELATIONS

LEGISLATIVE: Articles 245-255 + Seventh Schedule

POWER / PROCEDURE

ADMINISTRATIVE: Articles 256-263

FINANCIAL: Articles 264-293 + GST Articles 246A / 269A / 279A

CHECK / LIMIT

INTER-STATE / ECONOMIC: Articles 261-263 and 301-307

OPERATING QUESTION

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

Who may act → through which constitutional route → with what check → with what remedy?

FEDERALISM IS NOT ONE LIST legal competence + implementation control + fiscal capacity + bargaining institutions.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Article 246(2) creates concurrent competence; Article 246(3) gives State List competence subject to clauses (1) and (2).

01

STAGE 01

LEGISLATIVE COMPETENCE BEFORE CONFLICT

LEGISLATIVE COMPETENCE BEFORE CONFLICT

ARTICLE 245

TERRITORIAL REACH

WHOLE OR ANY PART OF INDIA; EXTRA-TERRITORIAL OPERATION PROTECTED

STATE LEGISLATURE

WHOLE OR ANY PART OF THE STATE; TERRITORIAL NEXUS

ARTICLE 246 + SEVENTH SCHEDULE

UNION LIST 100

ARTICLE 245: territorial reach

Parliament: whole or any part of India; extra-territorial operation protected

State legislature: whole or any part of the State; territorial nexus applies

ARTICLE 246 + SEVENTH SCHEDULE

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

ARTICLE 245: territorial reach

Parliament: whole or any part of India; extra-territorial operation protected

State legislature: whole or any part of the State; territorial nexus applies

POWER / PROCEDURE

ARTICLE 246 + SEVENTH SCHEDULE

Union List 100 → Parliament

State List 61 → States, subject to constitutional exceptions

CHECK / LIMIT

Concurrent List 52 → both: Article 254 resolves repugnancy

SPECIAL RULES

Article 246A → GST competence

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

Article 248 + Union Entry 97 → residuary power with Parliament.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A legally State subject may depend on Union finance; a shared tax may require administrative coordination; a water dispute may become a political and fiscal conflict.

02

STAGE 02

PARLIAMENT'S ROUTES INTO THE STATE FIELD

PARLIAMENT'S ROUTES INTO THE STATE FIELD

STATE LIST IS PRIMARY, NOT ABSOLUTE

ARTICLE 249

RAJYA SABHA NATIONAL-INTEREST RESOLUTION

ARTICLE 250

NATIONAL EMERGENCY; TEMPORARY EXTENSION AFTER IT ENDS

ARTICLE 252

TWO OR MORE STATES REQUEST; OTHER STATES MAY ADOPT

STATE LIST IS PRIMARY, NOT ABSOLUTE

Article 249 → Rajya Sabha national-interest resolution

Article 250 → National Emergency; temporary extension after it ends

Article 252 → two or more States request; other States may adopt

Article 253 → treaty / international obligation implementation

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

STATE LIST IS PRIMARY, NOT ABSOLUTE

Article 249 → Rajya Sabha national-interest resolution

Article 250 → National Emergency; temporary extension after it ends

POWER / PROCEDURE

Article 252 → two or more States request; other States may adopt

Article 253 → treaty / international obligation implementation

Article 356 → Parliament legislates for the affected State

CHECK / LIMIT

Article 246(4) → territories not included in a State

EXAM CONTROL

State trigger, national trigger, duration and amendment/revocation control differ by route.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

Article 252 → two or more States request; other States may adopt

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Articles 249 to 253 permit Parliament to enter the State field through distinct triggers, but each route retains its own duration, consent or federal safeguard.

03

STAGE 03

DOCTRINES, REPUGNANCY AND STATE-LAW CONTROL

DOCTRINES, REPUGNANCY AND STATE-LAW CONTROL

FIRST RECONCILE COMPETENCE PITH AND SUBSTANCE

TRUE NATURE HARMONIOUS CONSTRUCTION

PRESERVE BOTH ENTRIES INCIDENTAL ENCRoACHMENT

TOLERATED WHEN SUBSTANCE IS COMPETENT COLOURABLE LEGISLATION

WHAT CANNOT BE DONE DIRECTLY CANNOT BE DISGUISED

THEN TEST ARTICLE 254

CONCURRENT FIELD + DIRECT CONFLICT

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

FIRST RECONCILE COMPETENCE pith and substance → true nature harmonious construction → preserve both entries incidental encroachment →

tolerated when substance is competent colourable legislation → what cannot be done directly cannot be disguised

POWER / PROCEDURE

THEN TEST ARTICLE 254

Concurrent field + direct conflict → Union law ordinarily prevails reserved State law + Presidential assent → operates in that State

CHECK / LIMIT

Parliament may later override

ASSENT CONTROL prior sanction != reservation; Articles 200-201 remain distinct procedures.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

FIRST RECONCILE COMPETENCE pith and substance → true nature harmonious construction → preserve both entries incidental encroachment →

tolerated when substance is competent colourable legislation → what cannot be done directly cannot be disguised

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

FIRST RECONCILE COMPETENCE pith and substance → true nature harmonious construction → preserve both entries incidental encroachment →

tolerated when substance is competent colourable legislation → what cannot be done directly cannot be disguised

POWER / PROCEDURE

THEN TEST ARTICLE 254

Concurrent field + direct conflict → Union law ordinarily prevails reserved State law + Presidential assent → operates in that State

CHECK / LIMIT

Parliament may later override

ASSENT CONTROL prior sanction != reservation; Articles 200-201 remain distinct procedures.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

FIRST RECONCILE COMPETENCE pith and substance → true nature harmonious construction → preserve both entries incidental encroachment →

tolerated when substance is competent colourable legislation → what cannot be done directly cannot be disguised

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: If the State legislature passes the returned Bill again, Article 201 does not impose the Article 200-style obligation that assent must follow.

04

STAGE 04

ADMINISTRATIVE DIRECTIONS, DELEGATION AND COMMON SERVICES

ADMINISTRATIVE DIRECTIONS, DELEGATION AND COMMON SERVICES

STATE EXECUTIVE DUTY

ARTICLE 256

ENSURE COMPLIANCE WITH PARLIAMENTARY LAW

ARTICLE 257

DO NOT IMPEDE UNION EXECUTIVE POWER; DIRECTIONS IN STATED

ARTICLE 365

NON-COMPLIANCE MAY SUPPLY MATERIAL

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

STATE EXECUTIVE DUTY

Article 256 → ensure compliance with parliamentary law

Article 257 → do not impede Union executive power; directions in stated fields

POWER / PROCEDURE

Article 365: non-compliance may supply material

Article 356: still requires separate constitutional satisfaction and review

COOPERATIVE ADMINISTRATION

CHECK / LIMIT

Articles 258 / 258A → mutual entrustment of functions

Article 312 → Rajya Sabha route for All-India Services

CBI → DSPE Act consent architecture; State consent and federal litigation remain bounded.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

Article 365: non-compliance may supply material

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Failure to comply with Union directions permits the President to hold that a situation has arisen in which State government cannot be carried on according to the Constitution.

05

STAGE 05

FISCAL FEDERALISM FROM TAX POWER TO BORROWING

FISCAL FEDERALISM FROM TAX POWER TO BORROWING

NO TAX WITHOUT AUTHORITY OF LAW: ARTICLE 265 assigned / distributed taxes: Articles 268-270 surcharge

ARTICLE 265 ASSIGNED

DISTRIBUTED TAXES

ARTICLES 268-270 SURCHARGE FOR UNION PURPOSES

ARTICLE 271 GRANTS

ARTICLES 273, 275 AND 282

FINANCE COMMISSION

NO TAX WITHOUT AUTHORITY OF LAW: ARTICLE 265 assigned / distributed taxes: Articles 268-270 surcharge for Union purposes

Article 271 grants: Articles 273, 275 and 282

Finance Commission: Article 280 borrowing: Articles 292-293

GST LAYER

Articles 246A + 269A + 279A → shared tax field + destination rule + Council

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

NO TAX WITHOUT AUTHORITY OF LAW: ARTICLE 265 assigned / distributed taxes: Articles 268-270 surcharge for Union purposes

Article 271 grants: Articles 273, 275 and 282

POWER / PROCEDURE

Finance Commission: Article 280 borrowing: Articles 292-293

GST LAYER

CHECK / LIMIT

Articles 246A + 269A + 279A → shared tax field + destination rule + Council

CURRENT CONTROL

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

Sixteenth Finance Commission award 2026-31; report tabled in Parliament.

Fiscal autonomy depends on predictable devolution, not State List words alone.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: "More devolution" cannot be assessed from the percentage alone; the divisible-pool base, grants and expenditure mandates matter.

06

STAGE 06

INTERGOVERNMENTAL FORUMS AND RIVER-WATER ADJUDICATION

INTERGOVERNMENTAL FORUMS AND RIVER-WATER ADJUDICATION

ARTICLE 263 INTER-STATE COUNCIL INQUIRY + DISCUSSION + RECOMMENDATION

ZONAL COUNCILS

STATES REORGANISATION ACT, 1956; REGIONAL CONSULTATION; STATUTORY, NOT CONSTITUTIONAL

NORTH EASTERN COUNCIL

SEPARATE STATUTORY REGIONAL BODY

ARTICLE 262 WATER DISPUTES NEGOTIATION

STATUTORY TRIBUNAL

ARTICLE 263 INTER-STATE COUNCIL inquiry + discussion + recommendation; constitutional and recommendatory

ZONAL COUNCILS

States Reorganisation Act, 1956; regional consultation; statutory, not constitutional

North Eastern Council → separate statutory regional body

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

ARTICLE 263 INTER-STATE COUNCIL inquiry + discussion + recommendation; constitutional and recommendatory

ZONAL COUNCILS

POWER / PROCEDURE

States Reorganisation Act, 1956; regional consultation; statutory, not constitutional

North Eastern Council → separate statutory regional body

CHECK / LIMIT

ARTICLE 262 WATER DISPUTES negotiation → statutory tribunal → decision/publication → implementation

Parliament may exclude court jurisdiction through law

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

CURRENT LIMIT

The 2019 permanent-tribunal Bill has not become law; do not invent one tribunal.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Federal supremacy is constitutionally authorised but should be used only after competence and reconciliation analysis, not as a presumption that every Union law displaces State law.

07

STAGE 07

SARKARIA, PUNCHHI AND THE MODES OF FEDERALISM

SARKARIA, PUNCHHI AND THE MODES OF FEDERALISM

CONSULTATION AND JOINT IMPLEMENTATION

INNOVATION, INVESTMENT AND POLICY COMPARISON

NEGOTIATED GRANTS, GST AND POLITICAL ACCOMMODATION

CONDITIONAL FINANCE, DIRECTIONS OR UNILATERAL CENTRAL LEVERAGE

SARKARIA STRONG UNION WITHIN COOPERATION; ARTICLE 356 LAST RESORT

PUNCHHI LOCALISED EMERGENCY DEBATE; CLEARER GOVERNOR PRACTICE; CONSULTATION AND REFORM TEST REGULAR INSTITUTIONS + SHARED DATA + REASONED

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

COOPERATIVE → consultation and joint implementation

COMPETITIVE → innovation, investment and policy comparison

POWER / PROCEDURE

BARGAINING → negotiated grants, GST and political accommodation

COERCIVE → conditional finance, directions or unilateral central leverage

CHECK / LIMIT

SARKARIA strong Union within cooperation; Article 356 last resort; neutral Governor; active ISC

PUNCHHI localised emergency debate; clearer Governor practice; consultation and dispute prevention

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

REFORM TEST regular institutions + shared data + reasoned decisions + fiscal transparency.

COOPERATIVE → consultation and joint implementation

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Parliamentary law may confer powers and impose duties on States even without consent, with adjustment for administrative costs.

08

STAGE 08

PRELIMS CONTROLS, PYQ ROUTES AND ANSWER SYNTHESIS

PRELIMS CONTROLS, PYQ ROUTES AND ANSWER SYNTHESIS

PRELIMS FIREWALL

ARTICLE 254

CONCURRENT REPUGNANCY, NOT EVERY UNION-STATE DISAGREEMENT

ARTICLE 365

POSSIBLE CONSEQUENCE, NOT AUTOMATIC PRESIDENT'S RULE

ARTICLE 246A SPECIAL FIELD, NOT A GENERAL CONCURRENT LIST

ZONAL COUNCILS

PRELIMS FIREWALL

Article 254 → Concurrent repugnancy, not every Union-State disagreement

Article 365 → possible consequence, not automatic President's Rule

GST → Article 246A special field, not a general Concurrent List tax entry

Zonal Councils → statutory; Inter-State Council → constitutional

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

PRELIMS FIREWALL

Article 254 → Concurrent repugnancy, not every Union-State disagreement

Article 365 → possible consequence, not automatic President's Rule

POWER / PROCEDURE

GST → Article 246A special field, not a general Concurrent List tax entry

Zonal Councils → statutory; Inter-State Council → constitutional

PYQ ROUTES

CHECK / LIMIT

2019 supremacy/harmony

2020 centralisation

2024 relation reform

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

2025 fiscal federalism

MAINS SPINE define dimension → cite Article/institution → explain mechanism → evidence

State/Union counterpoint → commission reform → cooperative, reviewable conclusion.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Revenue-deficit, sector-specific and State-specific grants were discontinued in the accepted framework; local-body and disaster grants remain major grant channels.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

18. REPRESENTATION AS A FOURTH CENTRE-STATE DIMENSION - OPTIONAL

19. EXECUTIVE FEDERALISM AND INSTITUTIONAL UNDER-USE - OPTIONAL

STATE INFLUENCE AT THE UNION DEPENDS NOT ONLY ON

THE 42ND, 84TH AND 87TH AMENDMENT SEQUENCE SEPARATED INTER-STATE

[CURRENT] THE 2026 DELIMITATION PACKAGE WAS DEFEATED; ITS PROPOSED

[ANALYSIS] REPRESENTATION AND DEVOLUTION ARE TWO CURRENCIES OF THE

[LIMIT] FULL REPRESENTATIONAL-FEDERALISM TREATMENT BELONGS TO POLITY 12 AND

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE

18. Representation as a fourth Centre-State dimension - optional

19. Executive federalism and institutional under-use - optional

State influence at the Union depends not only on Lists and transfers but on seats in Lok Sabha, Rajya Sabha and the Presidential Electoral College.

The 42nd, 84th and 87th Amendment sequence separated inter-State seat allocation freeze from permissible intra-State boundary readjustment.

ADVANCED LIMIT

[CURRENT] The 2026 delimitation package was defeated; its proposed 850-seat figure is not law.

[ANALYSIS] Representation and devolution are two currencies of the same grievance where population growth affects both political and fiscal weight.

[LIMIT] Full representational-federalism treatment belongs to Polity 12 and Parliament; no seat projection or implementation date should be invented.

Much Indian federal coordination occurs among Prime Minister, Chief Ministers, ministers and officials rather than through legislatures.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

Executive federalism can respond quickly but may weaken transparency and opposition participation.

Zonal mechanisms often solve operational questions; the ISC should address national structural disputes.

A stronger ISC secretariat, regular agenda cycle and response-to-recommendation duty would turn consultation into accountable process.

The operative mechanism matters because [CURRENT] The 2026 delimitation package was defeated; its proposed 850-seat figure is not law.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.